

The Moon

Our Moon is a cold, dusty world that moves around the Earth in space. There is no air and almost no water on the Moon, so nothing can live there. Scientists think that the Moon is around 4.5 billion years old.

The Moon spins once during each orbit of the Earth.

In addition to craters, there are mountains and valleys on the Moon's surface.

Battered surface

The surface of the Moon is covered in craters. These have been caused by meteors crashing into it over millions of years.

The far side

The Moon takes the same time to turn all the way round as it does to go around the Earth. This means we always see the same side of the Moon. The far side can only be seen by spacecraft.

From the Earth, we only see the near side of the Moon.

Orbiting Moon

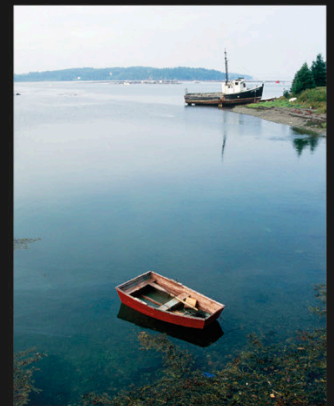
The Moon moves around the Earth once every 27 days. As the Moon, Sun, and Earth move, we see different amounts of the Moon lit by the Sun each night. These different views are called "phases."

Ocean bulges

The pull of gravity between the Moon and the Earth tugs on the Earth's oceans, making them bulge on either side of the planet. As the Earth turns, once every 24 hours, different parts of the oceans bulge—the sea's tides rise and fall.



Between the periods the water bulges, the ocean falls and it is low tide.



As each bulge arrives, the ocean rises and it is high tide.